

 JNTUK R23 · PATHFINDER

Nature

UNIT 2

REGULATION

R23

SEMESTER

II

SUBJECT

English

BOOK

Pathfinder

*"For men may come and men may go,
But I go on for ever."*

— Alfred Tennyson, *The Brook*

1

Lesson (Poem)

2

Grammar Topics

1

Reading Skill

1

Writing Skill

3

Vocabulary Sets

AUTHOR

About Alfred Tennyson

AT

Alfred, Lord Tennyson (1809 – 1892)

Alfred Tennyson was **Poet Laureate of the United Kingdom** for much of the Victorian era — one of the longest-serving laureates in history. Born in Lincolnshire, England, he showed a gift for language from childhood.

KEY WORKS

- *The Charge of the Light Brigade*
- *Break, Break, Break*
- *Ulysses*
- *The Lady of Shalott*
- *In Memoriam A.H.H.*
- *The Brook* (Unit 2 poem)

WRITING STYLE

- Master of **rhythm and musicality**
- Rich, descriptive **natural imagery**
- Deep use of **personification**
- Creates **vivid pictures with simple words**
- Themes: Nature, Time, Immortality, Heroism

The Brook — Alfred Tennyson

In this poem, a **brook (small stream) narrates its own journey** — from its origin in the hills to its final destination, a river. Tennyson uses the brook as a symbol to explore themes of nature and the eternal cycle of life.

*I come from haunts of coot and hern,
I make a sudden sally
And sparkle out among the fern,
To bicker down a valley.*

*By thirty hills I hurry down,
Or slip between the ridges,
By twenty thorpes, a little town,
And half a hundred bridges.*

*Till last by Philip's farm I flow
To join the brimming river,
**For men may come and men may go,
But I go on for ever.***

*I chatter over stony ways,
In little sharps and trebles,
I bubble into eddying bays,
I babble on the pebbles.*

*With many a curve my banks I fret
By many a field and fallow,
And many a fairy foreland set
With willow-weed and mallow.*

*I chatter, chatter, as I flow
To join the brimming river,
**For men may come and men may go,
But I go on for ever.***

*I wind about, and in and out,
With here a blossom sailing,
And here and there a lusty trout,
And here and there a grayling,*

*And here and there a foamy flake
Upon me, as I travel
With many a silvery waterbreak
Above the golden gravel,*

*And draw them all along, and flow
To join the brimming river
**For men may come and men may go,
But I go on for ever.***

*I steal by lawns and grassy plots,
I slide by hazel covers;
I move the sweet forget-me-nots
That grow for happy lovers.*

*I slip, I slide, I gloom, I glance,
Among my skimming swallows;
I make the netted sunbeam dance
Against my sandy shallows.*

*I murmur under moon and stars
In brambly wildernesses;
I linger by my shingly bars;
I loiter round my cresses;*

*And out again I curve and flow
To join the brimming river,
**For men may come and men may go,
But I go on for ever.***

GLOSSARY

Word Meanings

haunts

Places where one frequently spends time

<i>coot</i>	A water bird
<i>hern</i>	Old word for heron, another water bird
<i>sally</i>	A sudden movement out of a hidden place
<i>bicker</i>	To argue; here, to flow noisily
<i>thorpe</i>	A village or hamlet
<i>brimming</i>	Full to the brim
<i>sharps/trebles</i>	Musical notes (high-pitched sounds)
<i>eddy</i>	Moving in a circular way
<i>babble</i>	To make continuous noise — also describes the sound of a brook
<i>fret</i>	To wear down constantly (the banks)
<i>fallow</i>	Land ploughed but not yet sown
<i>foreland</i>	An area of land bordering another
<i>waterbreak</i>	An area of foaming or broken water in a stream
<i>hazel covers</i>	Small groups of hazel trees
<i>skimming swallows</i>	Swallows flying just over water without touching it
<i>brambly</i>	Thorny
<i>wilderness</i>	Jungle area, wild land
<i>linger</i>	To stay for a while
<i>shingly</i>	Full of shingles (small pebbles)
<i>loiter</i>	To walk aimlessly
<i>cresses</i>	Small edible weeds
<i>trout / grayling</i>	Types of fish

Summary of "The Brook"

The poem is written from the **first-person perspective of a brook** — a small stream. The brook describes its journey from the hills (where water birds like coots and herons live) through valleys, hills, villages, bridges, fields, and natural landscapes, until it merges with a large river.

Origin — The Hills

The brook begins its life among the haunts of water birds (coot and hern) and sparkles out through ferns in a valley.

The Journey Through the Land

It hurries past thirty hills, slips between ridges, passes through twenty villages and crosses fifty bridges. It chatters over stones, babbles on pebbles, makes musical sounds, and winds through fields and meadows.

Nature Along the Way

It passes lawns, grassy plots, hazel trees, forget-me-not flowers, trout and grayling fish, skimming swallows, and sunbeams reflected in its shallows.

The Destination — The River

The brook finally merges with a "brimming river" near Philip's farm. This is a natural ending — but the brook emphasises that it will flow on forever.

✦ CENTRAL MESSAGE / THEME

- **Immortality of Nature vs. Mortality of Man:** The famous refrain — "*For men may come and men may go, But I go on for ever*" — conveys that nature is **eternal and unchanging**, while human life is short and temporary.
- **Movement and Energy:** The brook is always active — chattering, babbling, sparkling, winding. This reflects nature's constant energy.
- **Beauty in Simplicity:** Using simple words, Tennyson creates a rich, musical picture of nature.

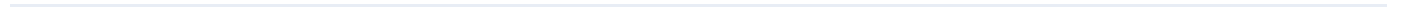
✓ POETIC DEVICES USED

- **Personification** — The brook speaks in first person ("I come", "I flow")
- **Alliteration** — "I slip, I slide, I gloom, I glance"
- **Onomatopoeia** — "chatter", "babble", "murmur"
- **Refrain** — The repeated lines emphasise the theme

MOOD OF THE POEM

- Joyful and lively
- Musical and rhythmic
- Peaceful yet energetic
- Subtly philosophical
- Celebratory of nature's beauty

- **Imagery** — "golden gravel", "silvery waterbreak", "netted sunbeam"



Listening for Main Idea & Supporting Ideas

When you listen to a speech or audio clip, you need to identify two key elements:

MAIN IDEA

The **central argument or topic** the speaker is discussing. It is usually stated near the beginning and sometimes repeated at the end. Ask yourself: *What is the speaker mainly talking about?*

SUPPORTING IDEAS

Examples, reasons, facts or arguments that the speaker provides to strengthen their main idea. These expand, explain or justify the central claim.

How to Listen Effectively

- 1 Listen for the **topic sentence** — usually first or last in a paragraph
- 2 Note **key words and phrases** (especially nouns, verbs, and connectives)
- 3 Identify **examples** introduced by "for example", "such as", "for instance"
- 4 Notice **contrast words** like "however", "but", "on the other hand"
- 5 Prepare a **bullet-point outline** of the speech using key words

✓ TYPES OF LISTENING EXERCISES (AS PER PATHFINDER)

- **Balanced Diet Speech:** Identify the components of a balanced diet — the main idea is the importance of a nutritious diet, supported by examples of food groups.
- **Debate/Discussion Clips:** Multiple speakers take turns. You must identify who agrees, who disagrees, and what reasons they give.
- **Persuasion Clips:** One speaker tries to convince another — note the central argument and counter-argument.

Short Talks

Short talks are brief, structured speeches on a specific topic delivered before your class. The goal is clear communication and confident delivery.

How to Prepare a Short Talk

- 1 Choose a topic (person you admire, a skill to learn, a place to visit, etc.)

- 2 Make short notes using key words and phrases only — do not write full sentences
- 3 Organise your talk: **Introduction** → **Details** → **Additional facts** → **Conclusion**
- 4 Practise speaking — **do not read out your notes**
- 5 Make eye contact with your audience as much as possible

Sample Talk: "A Person I Admire" — Deepika Mhatre

Deepika Mhatre is a Mumbai resident who begins her day at 4 a.m. She sells jewellery on trains until 6:30 a.m., then cooks in five homes until 4 p.m. On some evenings, she performs as a stand-up comedian. She got her break at a talent show for domestic workers and has since steadily gained recognition for her humour and wit. She is an inspiring example of determination, hard work, and humour in adversity.

◆ TALK TOPICS FROM PATHFINDER

- A person I admire
 - A skill I would like to learn
 - A historic place or monument
 - My favourite teacher
 - A memorable incident in my life
 - A city I would like to visit
 - A language I want to learn
 - An important social issue
-

Sequencing

Sequencing means **arranging ideas in a logical, meaningful order** so that the reader can easily follow the progression of thought. Good writing depends on clear sequencing.

Chronological

Arranging events according to time. Used when describing a sequence of events or steps.

e.g., "First, boil the water. Then, add tea leaves."

Spatial

Arranging ideas according to space or place. Used when describing places, scenes or layouts.

e.g., Describing a house room by room.

Logical

Arranging ideas based on cause-and-effect. Used when emphasising the interconnection of ideas.

e.g., "Because it rained, the match was cancelled."

◆ KEY POINTS ON SEQUENCING

- Sentences must connect logically — each sentence should follow naturally from the previous one
- Use **cohesive devices** (connectives) to make the sequence clear
- The topic sentence should be placed at the **beginning or end** of a paragraph
- Avoid jumping between ideas abruptly — this confuses the reader
- When sentences are jumbled, find the **opening general statement** first, then add specific details in order

Practice: Sequencing Sentences

Below is an example of correctly sequenced sentences about a dictionary:

- One of the most important reference books is a dictionary.
- You do possess one, but do you know all it contains?
- It contains the meanings of words.
- It also gives you the pronunciation.
- The dictionary can be referred to for grammatical forms.
- Every college dictionary provides pronunciation, meaning, grammatical patterns and usage.
- Finally, a good dictionary contains illustrative sentences showing how words are used.

Correct Sequence: b → a → d → c → e → f → g

Paragraph Writing

A paragraph is a group of sentences that discuss **one main idea**. Good paragraph writing is a key exam skill.

Steps to Write a Good Paragraph

- 1 Think about the topic and brainstorm **5–10 ideas**
- 2 Remove irrelevant points — **one paragraph = one theme only**
- 3 Arrange points in **chronological, sequential, or logical order**
- 4 Place the **topic sentence at the beginning or end**
- 5 Expand points into complete, well-structured sentences
- 6 Keep the **audience and purpose** in mind when choosing style
- 7 Use **connectives and transition words** for flow
- 8 Vary **sentence length and structure** to make the paragraph interesting
- 9 Do not make paragraphs too long — keep them focused
- 10 Proofread for **spelling, grammar, punctuation** and word choice

✦ SAMPLE PARAGRAPH — "THE IMPORTANCE OF SPORTS"

Sports play a vital role in the overall development of an individual. First, regular physical activity improves health and builds strength and stamina. Moreover, team sports teach students the values of cooperation, discipline and leadership. In addition, sports provide relief from academic stress and help students maintain mental balance. Furthermore, participation in sports at a competitive level can open opportunities for scholarships and careers. In conclusion, every student should engage in at least one sport, as it contributes to both physical fitness and personal growth.

Paragraph Writing Topics (from Pathfinder)

Short Paragraphs (120–150 words)

- My views on college life
- The importance of sports
- Superstitions
- Don't judge a book by its cover
- Actions speak louder than words
- Practice makes perfect

Longer Paragraphs (200–300 words)

- My favourite season
 - A street scene in a marketplace
 - Admission time at colleges
 - Advertisements: a necessary annoyance?
 - Privacy in the internet age
 - Social media and the youth
-

Cohesive Devices (Connectives)

Cohesive devices help readers understand the **relationships and connections between ideas and sentences**. Connectives (also known as linkers or transitional devices) are a key type of cohesive device.

Time Relationship

first, second, third, next, now, then, after, afterward, before, previously, subsequently, finally, thus, hence, soon, eventually, meanwhile

Contrast / Difference

though, although, but, however, nonetheless, nevertheless, unlike, yet, still, in contrast, in spite of, despite, rather than, of course, once in a while, sometimes

Causation

because, because of, caused by, due to, as, for, since

Adding Information

and, also, besides, first, second, third, furthermore, another, in addition, moreover

Conclusion

finally, in conclusion, to conclude, to sum up

Examples / Clarification

for example, for instance, to illustrate, such as

Comparison

as...as, as if, compared to, by comparison, in comparison, like, likewise, similarly

Effect / Result

consequently, as a result, for this/that reason, that is why, therefore, thus, so

✓ QUICK PRACTICE — FILL IN THE BLANKS (ANSWERS)

1. He prefers to read a book **rather than** watch a film.
2. **Following a healthy debate**, the members arrived at a broad consensus.
3. Wait until next week; **then** you will be able to buy the book at a discount.
4. Adil attends classes regularly, **unlike** his brother who is always irregular.
5. The idea of taking up this area for research is good; **however**, there are many practical difficulties.
6. **Though** she eats eggs for protein, she doesn't like them.
7. Did you hear about the coach's death? It was **caused by** a heart attack.
8. Green Valley School has a strong academic programme; **moreover**, it has excellent extra-curricular facilities.

Articles — a, an, the

Articles come before nouns and help identify whether the noun refers to something specific or general.

Article	Type	Use	Example
a	Indefinite	Before consonant sounds	<i>a</i> book, <i>a</i> university (/j/ sound)
an	Indefinite	Before vowel sounds	<i>an</i> apple, <i>an</i> honest man (/h/ silent)
the	Definite	Specific / already mentioned	<i>the</i> book (specific), <i>the</i> Himalayas
—	Zero Article	No article needed	peace, milk, proper nouns, abstract nouns

Uses of Indefinite Articles (a / an)

- Before a noun introduced for the **first time**: *"I met a doctor today."*
- Before a noun representing a **whole class**: *"A doctor must have compassion."*
- To indicate the **numeral one**: *"I gave him a rupee."*
- With personal names when the person is a **stranger**: *"Father went with a Dr. Sen."*

Uses of the Definite Article (the)

- When a noun has already been **mentioned before**
- Before **mountain ranges, oceans, seas, rivers, lakes, groups of islands**: *the Himalayas, the Pacific Ocean, the Ganga*
- With **superlative adjectives**: *"She is the fastest sprinter."*
- Before names of **countries with more than one word**: *the United States of America*
- With **holy books, famous buildings, newspapers**: *the Granth Sahib, the Rajdhani Express, the Indian Express*
- Before **compass points and geographic regions**: *the South Pole, the Middle East*

Zero Article — When NOT to Use an Article

- Before **proper nouns** (usually): *India, Hyderabad, Ravi*
- Before **abstract nouns**: *peace, love, happiness*
- Before **mass nouns**: *water, air, milk*
- Before **most diseases**: *cancer, typhoid* (but *a cold, a headache*)
- Before names of **meals**: *breakfast, lunch, dinner*
- Before **means of transport** with "by": *by train, by bus, by car*

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

- "All applicants must possess **an** a university degree." (university = /j/ sound)

- "I always use ~~a~~ **an** HB pencil." (H is pronounced 'aitch' — vowel sound)
 - "My brother is ~~electrical~~ **an electrical** engineer." (job title needs 'an')
 - "I am studying for ~~a~~ **an** MA in history." (M is pronounced 'em')
-

Prepositions

Prepositions are words placed **before nouns, noun phrases, pronouns, or gerunds** to link them to other words in a sentence. The word after a preposition is called its **object**.

SIMPLE PREPOSITIONS

about across after against
 along among around at
 before behind below beneath
 beside between by despite
 for from in into near of
 on through to under with
 without

COMPLEX PREPOSITIONS

along with away from because of
 due to except for in comparison to
 instead of together with in spite of

Functions of Prepositions

Function	Preposition	Example
Position	between, at, on	Sudha sits <i>between</i> Saroj and Usman.
Movement / Direction	from, to	Vijay went <i>from</i> Kanpur <i>to</i> Ahmedabad.
Time	at, on, in, since, for	Father returned <i>at</i> 6 o'clock.
Reason	because of, due to	The road is blocked <i>because of</i> the procession.
Purpose	for	We went to the market <i>for</i> vegetables.
Instrument	with	Jaya cut the lemon <i>with</i> a knife.
Means	by	Let's go to Mumbai <i>by</i> bus.
Concession	in spite of, despite	<i>In spite of</i> the heat, children played outdoors.
Comparison	like	She sings <i>like</i> a koel.

Common Noun–Preposition Combinations

Verb / Adjective / Noun	Preposition	Object
acceptable	to	someone
based	on	something (evidence, facts)
compare	with	someone or something
enrol	for / in	a course
participate	in	something
reason	for	something

Homonyms, Homographs & Homophones

Homonyms

Same spelling + same pronunciation but **different meanings**

*I wanted to **lie**.* → to say something untrue

*I wanted to **lie** down.* → to recline

Homographs

Same spelling but **different meanings** and sometimes **different pronunciations**

*The **wind** is strong.* (rhymes with 'pinned' = moving air)

*I forgot to **wind** my watch.* (rhymes with 'find' = to coil)

Homophones

Same pronunciation but **different spellings and meanings**

*Do not **waste** paper.* → spend thoughtlessly

*She tied a sash around her **waist**.* → part of body

Common Homonym Examples

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
bank	Financial institution	Sloping land beside a water body
fair	Free from bias	Lightly coloured / Travelling exhibition
suit	Set of garments	Legal proceedings / To be acceptable
scale	Weighing instrument	Ratio / Standard of reference / To climb
lead	A type of metal	To be in charge of / Result in
wound	Injury	To coil or arrange around
close	To shut	Very near
tear	Liquid from the eye	To separate by force

Common Homophones

Word 1	Meaning	Word 2	Meaning
waste	to spend carelessly	waist	part of the body
road	a path	rode	past tense of ride
board	a flat piece of wood	bored	feeling uninterested
principal	head of a school	principle	a rule or belief
their	belonging to them	there	at that place

Word 1	Meaning	Word 2	Meaning
to	in the direction of	too	also / excessively
reign	rule of a monarch	rain	water from clouds
wear	to put on clothes	ware	goods for sale

Exam Preparation Tips

✓ WRITING EFFECTIVE ANSWERS

- Always begin with a topic sentence that directly answers the question
- Use evidence from the poem/text to support your answer
- For poem questions, quote a relevant line and explain it
- Structure long answers: Introduction → Body → Conclusion
- Use connectives to improve flow: "Furthermore...", "In addition...", "However..."
- End with a thoughtful concluding sentence

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

- Do not just copy the question back as your answer
- Avoid writing vaguely — be specific and detailed
- Do not confuse **homonyms, homographs and homophones**
- Avoid article errors — check if a noun starts with vowel or consonant sound
- Do not use wrong prepositions — learn common noun-preposition pairs
- Avoid very long paragraphs with no clear structure

✦ TIME MANAGEMENT IN EXAM

- Read all questions first — **spend 2 minutes planning**
- Short answer (50–60 words): allocate **4–5 minutes each**
- Long answer (200 words): allocate **12–15 minutes each**
- Grammar / vocabulary exercises: **2–3 minutes each**
- Save **5 minutes at the end** for revision and corrections

LAST-DAY REVISION CHECKLIST ✓

- ✓ Revise the full poem "The Brook" and its theme/refrain
- ✓ Memorise the glossary words
- ✓ Revise types of cohesive devices with examples
- ✓ Revise uses of articles — especially zero article and tricky cases
- ✓ Practise article fill-in-the-blank exercises
- ✓ Revise homonyms, homographs, homophones tables
- ✓ Review paragraph writing steps
- ✓ Practice sequencing sentences with connectives

Short Answer Questions (50–60 words)

Q1. What kind of landscape is described in the first three stanzas of "The Brook"?

The first three stanzas describe a hilly, rural landscape. The brook begins near water birds (coot and heron) and flows through valleys, hills, ridges, small villages (thorpes), and bridges. The landscape is wild, natural, and energetic. The brook moves quickly and noisily, making its way through a rugged countryside before arriving near Philip's farm.

Q2. What are the types of water bodies and plant life mentioned in the poem?

The poem mentions the brook itself, eddying bays, the brimming river, sandy shallows, and shingly bars. Plant life includes fern, willow-weed, mallow, forget-me-nots, cresses, and hazel trees. These natural elements make the poem rich in imagery, painting a detailed picture of the brook's journey through varied natural landscapes.

Q3. Explain: "I make the netted sunbeam dance / Against my sandy shallows."

This line describes the brook reflecting sunlight. As sunlight falls on the water, the brook's movement makes it appear as if the beams of light are dancing. The word "netted" suggests the sunlight is caught in the water's surface like a net. This is a beautiful image of light, water, and movement in nature.

Q4. What is the mood of the poem "The Brook"?

The mood of the poem is joyful, lively, and musical. The brook describes its journey with enthusiasm and pride. There is a sense of freedom and energy as it moves through various landscapes. Beneath the cheerful tone lies a philosophical note about the permanence of nature compared to the brief lives of human beings.

Q5. What is Sequencing? What are the three types of sequence?

Sequencing means arranging ideas in a certain order to give writing a logical flow. There are three main types: (1) **Chronological** — according to time; (2) **Spatial** — according to space or place; and (3) **Logical** — according to a cause-and-effect relationship. Good sequencing helps readers follow the argument easily and understand the text clearly.

Q6. What are cohesive devices? Give examples.

Cohesive devices help readers understand relationships between ideas and sentences in a text. Connectives are an important type. They include words that show time (first, then, finally), contrast (however, although), cause (because, since), addition (moreover, furthermore), and conclusion (to sum up, in conclusion). Example: "She was tired; *however*, she completed the work."

Q7. Differentiate between homonyms, homographs, and homophones with examples.

Homonyms — same spelling and pronunciation, different meanings: *lie* (to tell a falsehood / to recline).

Homographs — same spelling, different meanings (sometimes pronunciation): *wind* (moving air / to coil).

Homophones — same pronunciation, different spellings and meanings: *waste* (to squander) / *waist* (part of body).

Q8. What are the steps to write a good paragraph?

To write a good paragraph: (1) Brainstorm 5–10 ideas on the topic. (2) Remove irrelevant points. (3) Arrange ideas logically. (4) Write a clear topic sentence. (5) Expand points into complete sentences. (6) Use connectives for smooth flow. (7) Proofread for grammar, spelling, and punctuation errors. Keep the paragraph focused on one single theme.

Long Answer Questions (200 words)

Q1. Explain the significance of the lines "For men may come and men may go, But I go on for ever."
What do they say about Nature?

These four lines form the recurring refrain (or chorus) of the poem "The Brook." They appear four times throughout the poem, serving as a powerful philosophical statement that ties together all the imagery of the brook's journey.

The lines establish a direct contrast between **human life and Nature**. Men — human beings — are described as temporary visitors. They come and go, meaning they are born and eventually die. Their presence on earth is brief, transient, and fragile.

In contrast, the brook — representing Nature — declares that it goes on **for ever**. This is a bold assertion of **Nature's immortality and permanence**. No matter how many generations of humans live and die, the brook continues to flow, the sun continues to shine, and the rivers continue to move.

This is not a pessimistic message about human mortality. Rather, it is a **celebration of Nature's enduring strength and beauty**. Nature is indifferent to the comings and goings of individuals. It was here before us, and it will remain long after us.

The refrain gives the poem its philosophical depth, transforming a simple nature poem into a reflection on life, time, and eternity. Tennyson, through the voice of the brook, reminds us to appreciate and respect the natural world that outlasts us all.

Q2. How does Tennyson use imagery to describe the landscape, flowers, plants, and colours in "The Brook"? How does it make you feel as a reader?

Alfred Tennyson creates extraordinarily vivid imagery in "The Brook" by piling detail upon detail to paint a rich picture of the natural world. He uses a variety of poetic techniques to bring the landscape to life.

Landscape Imagery: The poem describes thirty hills, ridges, fields, fallow land, shingly bars, grassy plots, and lawns. These images create a sense of vastness and variety — the brook passes through a whole countryside, not just one narrow valley.

Plant Life: Tennyson mentions ferns (where the brook begins), willow-weed, mallow, hazel trees, and forget-me-nots. The forget-me-nots are particularly lovely — described as blooming "for happy lovers," adding a romantic and tender quality to the poem.

Colour and Light: The poem glows with colour — "golden gravel," "silvery waterbreak," "foamy flake," and the sunbeams dancing on the water. These colour words make the poem feel almost like a painting.

Sound Imagery: Words like "chatter," "babble," "murmur," and "sharps and trebles" make the brook sound alive — like a musical instrument.

As a reader, this imagery creates a **feeling of peace, joy, and wonder**. The poem invites us to slow down and appreciate the small beauties of the natural world — a dancing sunbeam, a forget-me-not, a chattering stream. It makes nature feel both intimate and eternal.

Q3. Write a paragraph (200 words) on the topic: "The Importance of Sports."

Sports are not just games — they are a vital part of a student's overall development. First and foremost, regular physical activity improves health by building strength, stamina, and immunity. Students who engage in sports are less prone to lifestyle diseases like obesity and diabetes. Furthermore, team sports such as cricket, football, and basketball teach students the importance of cooperation, communication, and collective effort. These are qualities that are equally valuable in professional life. In addition to physical benefits, sports play an important role in mental health. Physical activity releases endorphins, reducing stress and anxiety, and helping students maintain emotional balance during academic pressure. Moreover, participation in sports builds self-confidence and resilience. When a student wins, they learn to celebrate success; when they lose, they learn to accept failure and work harder. Sports also teach students about discipline, time management, and the importance of consistent practice — values that transfer directly to academic achievement. Finally, talented students can benefit from sports scholarships and career opportunities. In conclusion, sports are far more than recreation. Every educational institution should encourage students to play a sport regularly, as it nurtures not just the body, but also the mind and character.

Q4. What are cohesive devices? Describe the different types with examples.

Cohesive devices are words, phrases, or grammatical tools that help connect ideas within a sentence or between sentences, making writing clear and meaningful. Among cohesive devices, **connectives** (also known as linkers or transitional devices) are the most commonly used in academic writing.

Time connectives show when things happen in relation to each other: *first, then, after, finally, subsequently, meanwhile*. For example: "We need to set our goals first. After that, we need to execute them."

Contrast connectives show difference or opposition: *however, although, nevertheless, despite, in contrast, yet*. For example: "I am not interested in the party. Nevertheless, thanks for reminding me."

Cause connectives show reason: *because, since, due to, caused by, as*. For example: "Since it is raining, the match may be cancelled."

Addition connectives add information: *furthermore, moreover, in addition, also, besides*. For example: "She will lead the basketball team. In addition, she is on the chess team."

Conclusion connectives signal an ending: *in conclusion, to sum up, finally*. These help the reader recognise when the argument is being wrapped up.

Using cohesive devices correctly makes writing more logical, professional, and easy to understand.

Previous Year Questions (JNTUK Pattern)

🎓 JNTUK PATTERN — SHORT ANSWER (5 MARKS)

Q1. What is the mood of the poem "The Brook"?

The mood of the poem is joyful, lively, musical, and energetic. The brook narrates its journey with pride and enthusiasm. There is a sense of freedom and beauty throughout. The repeated refrain adds a philosophical tone, suggesting that while human life is short, Nature is eternal. The poem celebrates the beauty and permanence of the natural world.

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Q2. Explain the use of personification in "The Brook."

Personification is the main poetic device in "The Brook." The entire poem is written from the first-person perspective of the brook — "I come," "I flow," "I chatter," "I murmur." This gives the brook a human-like voice, personality, and emotions. It makes the brook seem alive and relatable, and allows Tennyson to explore the theme of nature's immortality in a personal, direct way.

🎓 JNTUK PATTERN — LONG ANSWER (10 MARKS)

Q3. Explain "For men may come and men may go, But I go on for ever." What does it say about Nature?

These lines form the central refrain of the poem. They appear four times, reinforcing the poem's key philosophical message. The contrast is between human life (temporary) and Nature (eternal). Men come and go — they are born and die — but the brook continues flowing forever. Tennyson uses the brook as a symbol for the permanence of Nature. While civilisations rise and fall, and individuals live brief lives, Nature remains unchanged and everlasting. This reminds us of the importance of appreciating and protecting the natural world, which outlasts all human endeavours. The refrain transforms a simple nature poem into a profound meditation on time, life, and eternity.

🎓 JNTUK PATTERN — GRAMMAR (5 MARKS)

Q4. Fill in the blanks with appropriate articles (a, an, the, or X): (i) ___ peacock is in danger of extinction. (ii) I always use ___ HB pencil. (iii) My brother is ___ electrical engineer. (iv) She doesn't own ___ car. (v) ___ Sun is at its highest point at noon.

- (i) **The** peacock is in danger of extinction. (referring to the species as a class)
- (ii) I always use **an** HB pencil. (H is pronounced 'aitch' — vowel sound)
- (iii) My brother is **an** electrical engineer. (vowel sound 'e')
- (iv) She doesn't own **a** car. (first mention, consonant sound)
- (v) **The** Sun is at its highest point at noon. (unique object)

JNTUK PATTERN — VOCABULARY (5 MARKS)

Q5. Explain with examples: homonyms, homographs, homophones.

Homonyms share the same spelling and pronunciation but have different meanings. Example: *bank* (financial institution / side of a river). **Homographs** share the same spelling but may differ in pronunciation and always differ in meaning. Example: *wind* (moving air, rhymes with 'pinned' / to coil, rhymes with 'find'). **Homophones** sound the same but are spelled differently with different meanings. Example: *to / too / two; their / there / they're*.

JNTUK PATTERN — WRITING (10 MARKS)

Q6. Write a paragraph of about 200 words on the topic: "Social Media and the Youth."

Social media has become an inseparable part of youth culture in the twenty-first century. Platforms like Instagram, YouTube, Twitter, and WhatsApp have transformed the way young people communicate, learn, and express themselves. First, social media enables instant communication across the world, helping students connect with peers, educators, and experts. Furthermore, it serves as a powerful platform for creative expression — students share their art, writing, music, and ideas with global audiences. In addition, social media plays an important role in raising awareness about social issues. Youth-led movements on climate change, mental health, and education have gained momentum largely through social media campaigns. However, there are significant concerns. Excessive use of social media has been linked to reduced attention spans, poor academic performance, and mental health issues like anxiety and depression. Moreover, the spread of misinformation and cyberbullying pose serious risks. It is, therefore, important for young people to develop digital literacy — the ability to use social media wisely and critically. In conclusion, social media is a powerful tool that can be both beneficial and harmful. With proper awareness, moderation, and responsible usage, the youth can harness social media for positive personal and social growth.

CONCLUSION

Unit 2 — Recap & Conclusion

Topics Covered in Unit 2

- ✓ **Poem:** "The Brook" by Alfred Tennyson — themes of Nature, immortality, journey
- ✓ **Listening:** Identifying main idea and supporting ideas in audio clips
- ✓ **Speaking:** Giving structured short talks on specific topics
- ✓ **Reading:** Sequencing — chronological, spatial, logical ordering

Key Takeaways

- Nature is eternal — human life is temporary (Tennyson's message)
- Good writing needs logical sequencing and cohesive devices
- Articles depend on the *sound* (not the letter) of the following word
- Prepositions show time, place, cause, means, and manner

- ✓ **Writing:** Paragraph writing techniques and practice topics
- ✓ **Grammar:** Cohesive devices (connectives), Articles (a, an, the), Prepositions
- ✓ **Vocabulary:** Homonyms, Homographs, Homophones
- Homonyms, homographs, and homophones can be tricky — learn them carefully
- Paragraph writing: one paragraph = one main idea

Final Words

Unit 2 — Nature — teaches us more than grammar and vocabulary. Through Tennyson's brook, we learn to appreciate the world around us. Nature flows on, indifferent to our hurry and worry, yet beautiful in every moment. The skills you have practised here — writing, listening, sequencing, grammar — are tools for life, not just for exams.

Study with understanding, practise with patience, and write with clarity.

"For men may come and men may go, But I go on for ever."

— *Let Nature's persistence inspire your own.* 🌱